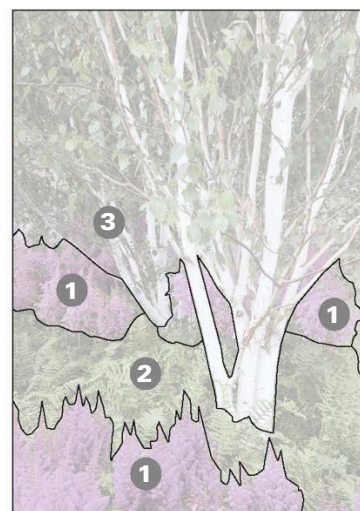




WOODLAND UNDERSTORY

This simple combination of ferns, purple astilbe, and the stark white stems of a Himalayan birch form an eye-catching display when the understory plants are repeated and set out in bold swathes. Ensure your soil is damp enough to please the astilbe, which prefers constant moisture. Adding a thick mulch of organic matter over clay soils in spring will help, or substitute them with Japanese anemone on free-draining sandy soils.



Plant list

- 1** *Astilbe x arendsii*
- 2** *Dryopteris affinis* 'Cristata'
- 3** *Betula utilis* var. *jacquemontii*